

Palm Pre

The Palm Pre is rumoured to release on March 15th after it's debut at CES 2009

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Gigabyte GA-EP45-UD3P

A new blue board

Gigabyte's GA-EP45-UD3P is based on the Intel P45 chipset, and is based on UD3. The PCBs used have improved heat conduction capabilities.

This board also has two PCIe x16 slots with CrossFireX capabilities. It also provides three PCIe x1 and two PCI slots.

During our tests, including Maxon Cinebench R10 and SiSoft Sandra, it matched other P45 chipset-boards.

The GA-EP45-UD3P board is great and has many features including the detailed BIOS designed for overclockers. The board is pretty decent in performance, great on features but it's a bit expensive at Rs 14,590.

Specifications:

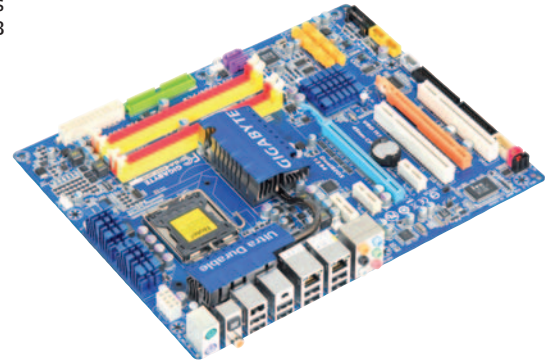
Intel P45 Express Chipset, Intel P45 Northbridge, Intel ICH10R Southbridge, 4 DDR2 SDRAM 240pin DIMM Sockets Supports DDR2-533/667/800 MHz, Supports up to 8 GB Total Memory (4x 2 GB)

Ratings (on 10)

Features: 8
Performance: 7.5
Build quality: 8
Value for money: 6.5
Overall: 7.5

Contact: GIGABYTE
Phone: +91-22-4063 3222

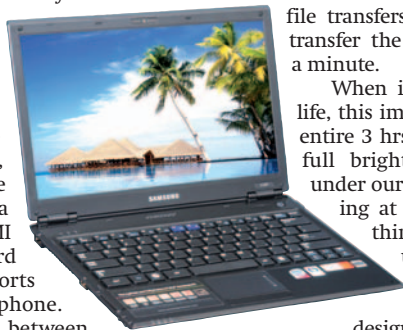
Email: viveks@gigabyte.in
Web site: www.gigabyte.in
Price: Rs. 14,590



Samsung X360

Sleek and stylish

The X360 is sleek and stylish and can get you drooling. It's really thin and light and even lighter when you take out the six-cell battery. An interesting feature on the battery is an indicator that approximately indicates the amount of power left in the battery – all with just the push of a button. On the right side of this notebook, there are two USB ports, one SD/XD/MS expansion slot, a VGA port and even an HDMI port. The left side has the third USB port, a LAN port and ports for a headphone and a microphone. The keyboard has spacing between the keys which gives a good solid feel while typing. It's somewhat similar to the Sony's laptops and Apple's Macbooks. The Function key gives access to additional



features such as an easy speed up mode that boosts the performance from 1.2 GHz to 1.6 GHz.

We ran some real world 1-GB file transfers and were able to transfer the file in under half a minute.

When it comes to battery life, this impresses. It lasted an entire 3 hrs and 39 mins with full brightness and volume under our stress test. So, looking at the facts, the only thing that does impress us is the battery life and the weight. Although the design is also pretty good,

this laptop is aimed only for those people who like to sit in coffee shops and show off their sleek laptops. As some would put it – beauty without brains. The price of the X360

is Rs 1,15,014 which is high but one must remember the SSD component to this PC. In terms of performance, it doesn't match the other notebooks in this price range.

Specifications

Processor: Intel Core 2 Duo U9300 @ 1.2 GHz, Main Chipset: Intel GS45 + ICH9MS. HDD: 128 GB(SSD), 1.3MP Integrated web Camera.

Ratings (on 10)

Features: 7
Performance: 6.5
Build quality: 7.5
Value for money: 5.5
Overall: 6.5

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Web site: www.samsung.com/in
Price: Rs. 1,15,014

ASUS P5KPL-AM/PS

For all your basic needs

ASUS' P5KPL-AM/PS is a mini – ATX board based on the G31 chipset.

This board comes with only two memory slots, but can hold up to 4 GB of DDR2 RAM. It has two PCI slots, one PCIe X1 slot and even a single PCIe X16 slot. This motherboard also comes with the integrated Intel Graphics Media Accelerator – GMA 3100. It has the Realtek ALC662 to support six channel High Definition audio.

This board is not a high performer, nor is one of the best when it comes to overclocking and integrated graphics. However, the Southbridge tends to heat up quite a bit. This motherboard is not meant for gaming. If you want better perform-



ing integrated graphics motherboard, then you should opt for the GeForce 9300.

Specifications:

Supports Intel 45 nm multi-core processors, Northbridge: Intel G31, Southbridge: ICH7, FSB 1600(O.C.)/1333/1066/800 MHz, DDR2

1066(O.C.)/800/667 MHz, 5000hrs VRM Solid Capacitors

Ratings (on 10)

Features: 6
Performance: 6
Build quality: 6
Value for money: 8
Overall: 6.5

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